# Tesla Sentry Mode Faces Problems in Europe, Where Filming in Public Places Is Prohibited

A German court hearing forces Tesla to warn owners of data privacy risks posed by the Sentry Mode cameras, as filming in public spaces is prohibited in Europe

Published: 6 Apr 2023, 14:45 UTC • By: Cristian Agatie






**protection regulations. Recording in public places without people's consent is prohibited under European laws, and this has caused Tesla to change the way it advertises Sentry Mode in Germany.**

Tesla Sentry Mode is a useful feature that combines security and dashboard camera features. The Sentry Mode footage often helped catch criminals who vandalized Tesla vehicles, quickly becoming a public favorite. Still, Tesla's feature has attracted unwanted attention from authorities and regulators, who worry Tesla cars might spy on others.

China was among the first to raise the issue, saying that Tesla might secretly record in sensitive areas such as military bases and other secret locations. Later, Tesla went under fire in Europe, where the General Data Protection Regulations (GDPR) prohibit recording people without their consent. In February, Tesla avoided a fine in the Netherlands after changing how Sentry Mode worked and made it clear to owners that they bear full responsibility for where and when the system records surrounding images.

Tesla faced similar charges in Germany after a local consumer association sued Tesla for filming in public without consent. Verbraucherzentrale Bundesverband (VZBV) filed a lawsuit last July alleging that the automaker was misleading consumers by not informing them in advertising that they could be violating data protection regulations. The lawsuit basically says that using Sentry Mode in public spaces to film passers-by without their knowledge is prohibited.

---

After a hearing in Berlin, Tesla issued a cease-and-desist declaration stating that it would change how it advertises the Sentry Mode in Germany. Like in the Netherlands, this concludes the case and allows Tesla to avoid being fined for violating privacy laws. Most probably, Tesla will also warn owners in Germany that they bear legal responsibility for using Sentry Mode.

spaces. The responsibility would extend to the company if images were transmitted to and stored by Tesla. This is similar to what happened in the Netherlands earlier this year. Tesla assured in that case that Sentry Mode footage is only stored in vehicles and changed the way the feature works. For instance, the car would flash lights to warn passers-by that footage is being recorded.

Based on the restrictions imposed by the European GDPR, it looks like Sentry Mode would not be that useful in Europe. Considering that all the countries in the European Union must enforce the same regulations, Tesla faces similar lawsuits across the continent. At some point, it might choose to cripple Sentry Mode or remove it altogether from the cars sold in Europe.

**Liked the article?** Follow us to see more articles from autoevolution in your Google feeds.

#TESLA #SENTRY MODE #GERMANY #GDPR #VZBV

About the author: **CRISTIAN AGATIE**



After his childhood dream of becoming a "tractor operator" didn't pan out, Cristian turned to journalism, first in print and later moving to online media. His top interests are electric vehicles and new energy solutions. Full profile →



*UP NEXT*

One-Off Honda CB836-CM Merges Utilitarian Looks With Classic CB750 Genes

## MORE ON THIS _

A Cool New Feature Will Arrive in Tesla Cars With Upcoming 2023.4 Software Update

Couple Tries to Disconnect a Tesla Left on Charge but Doesn't Know Sentry Mode Exists

Music Video Filmed Entirely Using Strangers' Teslas and Their Sentry Mode

Tesla Sentry Mode – The Fancy Loud Alarm System

## TESLA MODELS _

**TESLA Model Y**
Crossover

**TESLA Roadster**
Roadster & Convertible

**TESLA Model X**
Large SUV

**TESLA Roadster**
Coupe Cabrio

**TESLA Model Y**
Crossover

ALL TESLA MODELS →

## MORE NEWS _

He Bought a New Chevy Corvette in April 2026 and He Wants It Gone After Less Than 700 Miles

This Custom Island Tiny House Offers All the Comforts of a Full-Size Home and Storage Galore

Plymouth Superbird Crashed Its Nose at Car Meet, Insurance Paid $30K, the Car Sold for $170K

Durable Force Is the Bad Boy Face of the 2027 Kawasaki KLR650 Adventure Bike

2027 Ineos Grenadier Helmsman Launches New Special Edition Series Inspired by 'The Elements'

SEE ALL NEWS →

## MORE TESTDRIVES _

Ridden: 2026 Aprilia RS 660 Made Me Feel Younger for a Day

Driven: All-New 2026 Mazda CX-6e – a Smooth Operator at All Times

Driven: All-New 2026 Mercedes GLC 400 4MATIC Electric – Fast, Flashy and Gunning for the BMW iX3

Ridden: 2026 BMW F900 GS Adventure Made Me Rethink My Entire Life

Ridden: Ausom's K20 Pro E-Scooter Is a Sweet Deal at $730 but Leaves a Bit of Room for Growth

SEE ALL TESTDRIVES →

## MORE COVERSTORIES _

He Bought a New Chevy Corvette in April 2026 and He Wants It Gone After Less Than 700 Miles

Plymouth Superbird Crashed Its Nose at Car Meet, Insurance Paid $30K, the Car Sold for $170K

Kawasaki Floods the American Market With Tens of Returning Street Motorcycles of All Shapes and Size

New Zenos E10 Is a 380-HP British Sports Car That Weighs Less Than a Mazda MX-5 Miata

BMW's M2 Turbo Says Namaste From India

SEE ALL COVERSTORIES →

## MORE EDITORIALS _

Maybe Mercedes-AMG and Ferrari Were Right All Along: Jag's Type 01 Isn't Bad, Only a Little Generic

Modern Cars Look Like They Come From an Alternate Future

2027 Hyundai Tucson: Another Complete Change of Design, Inside & Outside, Reveals How Bold They Are

New EVs Already Have Better Range, Performance, and Prices Than Their Combustion Equivalents

I Can't Believe That BMW Is Making the ICE-Powered M350 xDrive Top Dog a Puppy Next to the i3 EV

SEE ALL EDITORIALS →

Baseus USB-A to USB-C Cable - Braidec



#ad

Anker USB-C to USB-C Cable - 2-Pack
3.3ft/1m 100W Fast Charging




#ad

© 2008-2026 SoftNews Net SRL, an independent publisher • Privacy Policy • Cookies Policy • Terms of Use
All rights reserved. autoevolution® and the autoevolution® logo are registered trademarks.